

B1.1.1.1 Verbs Changing Meaning in Past — Practice

Part A — Fill in the Blank (Preterite or Imperfect)

Choose the correct form of the verb in parentheses based on the intended meaning.

1. Yo no (saber) _____ que Juan estaba casado. (I didn't know Juan was married.)
2. Nosotros (conocer) _____ a los vecinos la semana pasada. (We met the neighbors last week.)
3. Ella (querer) _____ ir a la fiesta, pero tuvo que trabajar. (She wanted to go to the party, but had to work.)
4. Yo (no poder) _____ abrir la puerta, por más que lo intenté. (I tried and failed to open the door.)
5. ¿Cuándo (tú, saber) _____ la verdad? (When did you find out the truth?)
6. Yo ya (conocer) _____ ese museo antes de mudarme aquí. (I already knew that museum before moving here.)
7. Juan (no querer) _____ disculparse. (Juan refused to apologize.)
8. Al final, (yo, poder) _____ terminar el proyecto a tiempo. (In the end, I managed to finish the project on time.)

Part B — Translation (English to Spanish)

Translate each sentence, choosing the correct meaning-shift form.

1. I met my wife in college.
2. I didn't know you spoke French.
3. We found out the news through social media.
4. I tried to call you, but it got late.
5. We couldn't get in because the place was closed.

Part C — Meaning Check

Read each Spanish sentence and choose the correct English translation.

1. Supe que Juan se mudó a España. a) I knew Juan moved to Spain. b) I found out Juan moved to Spain.
2. Yo conocía muy bien esta ciudad. a) I met this city for the first time. b) I already knew this city well.
3. No quise responder a esa pregunta. a) I didn't want to answer that question. b) I refused to answer that question.
4. Pude terminar el examen a tiempo. a) I was able to (and did) finish the exam on time. b) I was generally capable of finishing exams on time.

Answer Key

Part A

1. sabía
2. conocimos
3. quería
4. no pude
5. supiste
6. conocía
7. no quiso
8. pude

Part B

1. Conocí a mi esposa en la universidad.
2. No sabía que hablabas francés.
3. Supimos la noticia por las redes sociales.
4. Quise llamarte, pero se me hizo tarde.
5. No pudimos entrar porque el lugar estaba cerrado.

Part C

1. b) I found out Juan moved to Spain.
2. b) I already knew this city well.
3. b) I refused to answer that question.
4. a) I was able to (and did) finish the exam on time.